Nova AI -- Onboarding Guide

Welcome to Nova AI

We're excited to have you on board! This guide will help you navigate your first weeks. Every new hire is assigned a buddy (a peer from your team) and a mentor (a senior IC or manager) to support your ramp-up.

First Week Checklist

- Day 1 -- Setup workstation, install dev tools, meet your team, review the handbook.
- Day 2 -- Complete security & compliance training (2 hours).
- Day 3 -- Shadow onboarding buddy on a small task, explore the codebase.
- Day 4 -- Submit your first small PR (documentation or test improvement).
- Day 5 -- One-on-one with manager, review first-week goals and next sprint assignment.

Team Structure

Nova AI has four engineering teams: Platform (core infrastructure, APIs, DevOps), AI/ML (LLM pipelines, evaluation, RAG), Frontend (React apps, design system), and Data (analytics, reporting, insights). Each team has a lead, 3-6 engineers, and a dedicated product manager. Cross-team collaboration happens through weekly syncs and an all-hands demo on Fridays.

Tools & Access

- Slack -- primary communication (channel naming: #team-*, #proj-*)
- GitHub -- all code, PRs, and project boards
- Notion -- internal docs, runbooks, meeting notes
- Linear -- task tracking and sprint planning
- 1Password -- team shared vaults and secrets
- Vercel / Render -- deployment dashboards (admin only)

Engineering Ramp-Up Goals

By week 2: submit 3+ PRs, understand the interview graph state machine. By week 4: own a small feature end-to-end, be on-call rotation ready. By week 8: lead a medium-sized project, participate in design reviews.